Smoke-Free Workplace Policy

Richtlinie zum Nichtraucherschutz am Arbeitsplatz

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Owner	Carlos Mendes, Safety Officer (Fachkraft für Arbeitssicherheit)
Approved by	Anja Richter, COO
Consulted	Workplace Safety Committee (Arbeitsschutzausschuss); Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat); Julia Neumann, HR Director; Dr. Sabine Lang, company physician (Betriebsärztin); Markus Vogel, Facilities Manager
Applies to	All employees, trainees, working students, interns, contractors, temporary agency staff and visitors at all sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt) and in company vehicles
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Purpose

This policy outlines our rules regarding smoking in the workplace. It aims to protect non-smokers without unreasonably depriving smokers of the opportunity to smoke. We follow the legal requirements on protecting non-smokers, in particular the Workplace Ordinance (Arbeitsstättenverordnung, ArbStättV) and the non-smoker protection laws of the German federal states in which we operate.

Employees who smoke need to follow this policy so that they:

- protect non-smokers from second-hand smoke;
- avoid setting off fire alarms and smoke detectors;
- help preserve an image of a clean workplace;
- avoid fires caused by discarded cigarettes.

2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees of Norvane Systems as well as to visitors, contractors and temporary staff. It covers all tobacco products as well as e-cigarettes (vapes) and heated tobacco products. Cannabis may not be consumed at work or on our premises (see also the Cannabis Act, KCanG, and NS-HR-POL-004).

3 Where smoking is not allowed

As a general rule, smoking is not allowed indoors. This applies to:

- working areas, including meeting rooms and home-office rooms used for company work;
- hallways and staircases;
- restrooms;
- warehouses, including the Garching depot and device-staging warehouse, and the Frankfurt data center;
- company vehicles;
- kitchens and cafeterias.

Smoking is prohibited indoors at any time, not just during working hours. If you stay late at work, you must still follow this policy. We do not currently provide indoor smoking rooms.

4 Where smoking is permitted

We permit smoking during normal breaks, and only at the designated smoking areas listed below:

Site	Designated smoking area	Notes
Munich HQ, Parkring 12	Courtyard terrace	Not at the building entrances or the north-side assembly point.
Berlin office	Roof terrace	Observe the house rules for the roof terrace.
Garching depot and warehouse	Marked area outside Gate 2	Never near vehicles, fuel, batteries or stored devices and packaging.
Frankfurt colocated data center	None	No smoking anywhere on the site.

Smoking on other outside areas, such as sidewalks and yards in front of our buildings, is not permitted, so that colleagues, neighbours and visitors are not disturbed. Smoking breaks are not working time unless they fall into your normal breaks. If you smoke outside your normal break, please record the time as a break in Personio.

We also advise our employees to:

- extinguish their cigarettes and discard them only in the containers provided;
- avoid smoking right before scheduled meetings with customers or vendors;
- avoid smoking near flammable objects and areas.

5 Our actions

We will:

- place signs at all areas where smoking is not allowed and at all designated smoking areas;
- communicate this policy through the intranet (intranet.norvane.example), the notice boards on each site and the onboarding programme;
- keep ashtrays and containers in the designated smoking areas emptied and safe;
- offer information on smoking cessation as part of our health offering, through the company physician (on site at HQ on Tuesdays), the employee assistance programme (EAP) and the Krankenkassen courses.

Any employee who has a complaint regarding this policy can contact HR, the Safety Officer or the Works Council (Betriebsrat). If an alarm is set off, follow the Emergency and Evacuation Procedure (NS-EHS-PRC-001).

6 Disciplinary consequences

We expect employees to respect this policy and their colleagues. We will take disciplinary action towards employees who disregard it:

Behaviour	Possible consequence
Employees who violate this policy infrequently or do not cause major issues	Conversation with the line manager, then a formal warning (Abmahnung) if repeated.
Employees who violate this policy frequently or cause severe problems (for example a fire)	Formal warning (Abmahnung) and, in serious cases, termination of employment, in accordance with German employment law and after hearing the Works Council (Betriebsrat).

Managers and HR are responsible for taking appropriate action after they have investigated any incident thoroughly.

7 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Policy owner, safety questions	Carlos Mendes, Safety Officer	carlos.mendes@norvane.example	2400
Complaints, HR questions	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Cessation advice	Dr. Sabine Lang, company physician	sabine.lang@norvane.example	2450

Smoking areas, signage, facilities	Markus Vogel, Facilities Manager	markus.vogel@norvane.example	6100
Employee representation	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Fire or emergency, building security (24/7)	Building security	security@norvane.example	9111

In an emergency call 112 (fire service and emergency services).

8 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-EHS-PRC-001	Emergency and Evacuation Procedure	Fire alarms and assembly points
NS-HR-POL-001	Employee Code of Conduct	General conduct
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies	Further workplace rules

9 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.09.2023	Carlos Mendes	First issue.
1.1	01.01.2026	Carlos Mendes	Site-specific smoking areas added; e-cigarettes and heated tobacco included; aligned with the Workplace Safety Committee.

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